

THRILLING CONTEST

To entertain his guests, the lord of the castle has invited famous knights to take on the local champion at a joust. The knights and their horses are dressed to impress. They charge at each other at top speed while the crowd cheers excitedly. Disappointingly, the castle's own knight is not doing well, and is about to take a tumble.



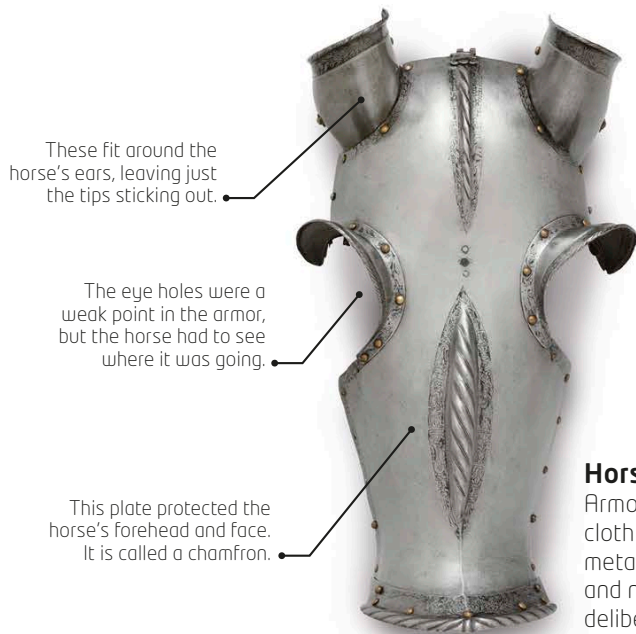
The ridged "comb" along the top of the helmet strengthened it and helped deflect lance blows against the head.

The eye slit allowed the knight to see what was coming toward him.

The visor over the face has breathing holes. It could be lifted up and out of the way.

Protective gear

Jousting knights wore metal plate armor, with chain mail underneath. Jousting armor was more elaborate than armor worn on the battlefield, and it was often intricately decorated.



These fit around the horse's ears, leaving just the tips sticking out.

The eye holes were a weak point in the armor, but the horse had to see where it was going.

This plate protected the horse's forehead and face. It is called a chamfron.

A young lady offers her sleeve to a knight as a token of her affection.

This knight will wear the lady's sleeve on his armor and joust in her honor.

This lady is a chaperone, here to keep an eye on the young lady beside her. She was too busy watching the action and now it's too late to stop the romance.



The horses wear padded fabric outfits called caparisons.

Horse safety

Armor wasn't just for humans. Padded cloth protected a horse's body, with metal plates often worn on the face and neck. It was thought unsporting to deliberately wound an opponent's horse.

Knights were men tied by oath to fight in wars for their lord or king. When not on the battlefield, they could take part in jousting tournaments.